Digital Citizenship

Creating Responsible 21st Century Digital Learners

Rhonda Tidgwell

As 21st century educators in a digital age, one of our most important roles is to build digitally responsible global citizens –nbd. But what does this look like? OSAPAC, in collaboration with the Ministry of Education, has created a resource to guide us through learning and teaching for the 21st century. They have divided digital citizenship up into four categories:

CRITICAL THINKING & INFORMATION LITERACY

A digital citizen is one who…

- uses effective strategies to search for information (e.g., keywords, narrowing a search)
- uses credible online resources (e.g., databases, encyclopedias, e-books)
- evaluates and reflects critically on information/resources/sites
- applies an inquiry model to gather, use and evaluate information in order to build knowledge

CREATION & CREDIT

A digital citizen is one who…

- respects intellectual property of others (e.g., paraphrases and gives credit)
- uses digital resources responsibly and adheres to user agreements
- understands and gives credence to the consequences of unauthorized distribution
- utilizes appropriate licensing options for personal creations (e.g., Creative Commons)

PRESENCE & COMMUNICATION

A digital citizen is one who…

- communicates appropriately according to the audience (e.g., conventions, voice, form)
- contributes positively to the local and global communities
- identifies and responds appropriately to online issues (e.g., cyberbullying, sexting, etc.)
- develops a positive reputation and digital footprint

HEALTH & PROTECTION

A digital citizen is one who…

- implements precautions for online security (e.g., passwords, settings)
- protects the privacy of self and others
- balances offline and online activities (e.g., gaming, texting, social networking, etc.)
- uses devices with attention to physical and mental health

From OSAPAC's Digital Citizenship, 2014/15 https://www.osapac.ca/dc/

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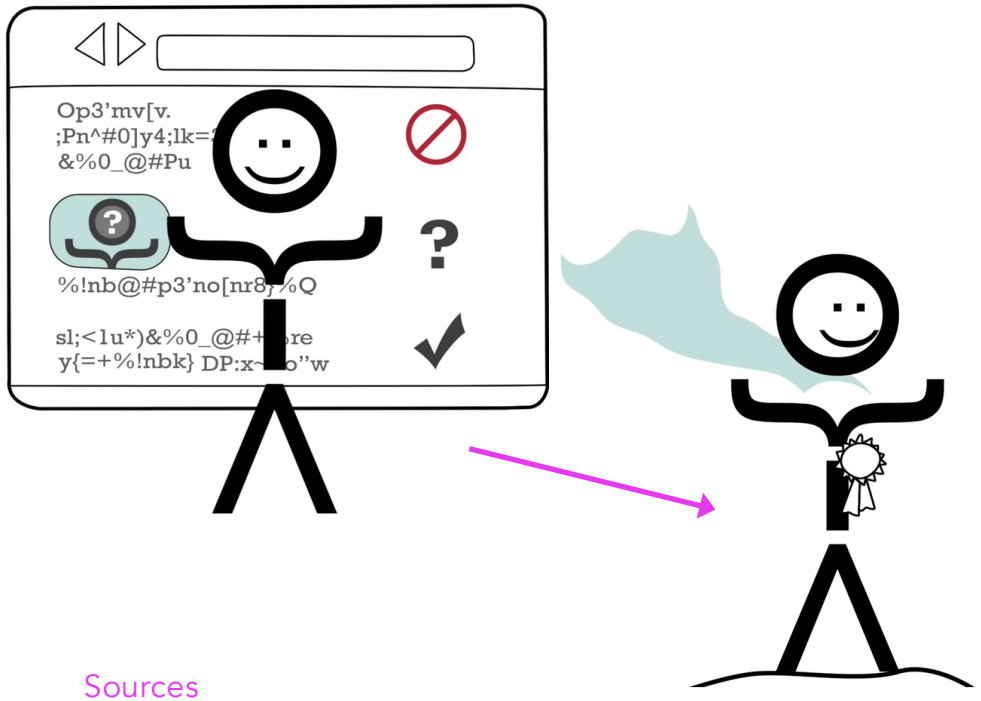
Digital citizenship is the idea that students

*"make productive, positive, and responsible contributions as members of a local, global or digital community."**

AREA OF FOCUS After looking at each of the four key areas of digital citizenship, I chose to share a short animated video focusing on Critical Thinking and Information Literacy.

VIDEO & LINK *Detecting Lies and Staying True*, Safety Centre Videos
The main message of the video is, "Just because information shows up online, doesn't mean its' true." The big ideas include being skeptical, investigating sources, using a variety of sources, and "staying true."
https://youtu.be/fXFbQKz3anw

HOW MIGHT THIS BE USED This short video would work well as a "minds-on" introduction to cyber-citizenship, or as a supplementary resource. It would be helpful in encouraging critical thinking skills, while using child-friendly language, to teach students to evaluate resources and reflect on their online behavior. I like that it ties in online integrity –"staying true," as well considering missing perspectives while evaluating resources.



Sources

OSAPAC, Digital Citizenship, 2014/15 https://www.osapac.ca/dc/
* 2_Support for Administrators_Digital Citizenship.pdf
Detecting Lies and Staying True, Safety Centre Videos, 2009